Announcements and reminders

- **The (entire) Levinson reading is now optional.**

- **Final exam: Monday, 27 Apr, 5pm-7pm, MPSH-2A**

  (Pre-assigned seating: your seat number will be available on EduRec. Bring your student ID.)

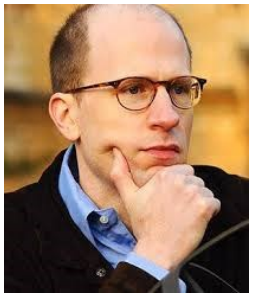
- We'll use Examplify, and the exam will be open book meaning you may bring one sheet of paper (handwritten or printed, A4 or smaller, double-sided). Rough/draft paper will be available from the invigilators as in the midterm exam. You should bring your own pen/pencil.

- Fully charge your laptop before the exam, if possible.

- The final exam questions will focus on Weeks 6-13 lectures and readings, but some questions will *combine* these materials with the Weeks 2-5 materials (Don't forget to study the Week 6 materials).

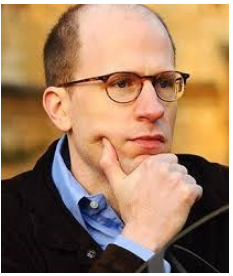
- As before, some questions may require you to know something in a reading that is not covered in lectures (except for Schneider, "The Problem of AI Consciousness" and Levinson, ""Defining Art Historically").

What kinds of evidence would be relevant to which of the three possibilities is true?



Nick Bostrom
(1973-)

"If we are in a simulation, could [we] ever know for certain? If the simulators don't want us to find out, we probably never will. But if they choose to reveal themselves, they could certainly do so. Another event that would let us conclude with a high degree of confidence that we are in a simulation is if we ever reach a point when we are about to switch on our own ancestor simulations. That would be very strong evidence against the first two propositions, leaving us only with the third.(p.9)



Nick Bostrom
(1973-)

At least one of the following three possibilities is true:

(a) "Almost all civilisations at our level of development become extinct before becoming technologically mature" 1/3

(b) "The fraction of technologically mature civilisations that are interested in creating ancestor simulations is almost zero" 1/3

(c) "You are almost certainly living in a computer simulation" 1/3

"if you think that possibilities one and two are both false, you should accept the third" (p.9)

"In reality, we don't have much specific information to tell us which of the three possibilities might be true. In this situation, it might be reasonable to distribute our credence roughly evenly between them" (p.9)

Bostrom might be wrong about this claim. But note that we should still assign a significant probability to (c), insofar as we think that there is a significant probability that both (a) and (b) are false.

Maurizio Cattelan
The Comedian (2019)

Marcel Duchamp
Fountain (1917)

What is the definition of art?

≈ necessary and sufficient condition for art

Piero Manzoni
Artist's Shit (1961)

Vincent van Gogh
The Starry Night (1889)

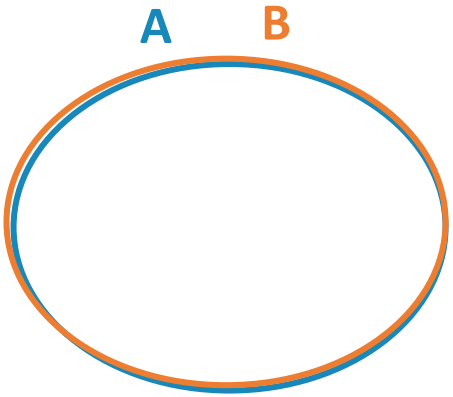
Necessary and Sufficient condition (we'll talk more about this later)

A is (a) necessary and sufficient (condition) for B

= A is sufficient for B and A is necessary for B
(and vice versa)

= A if and only if B

= B if and only if A



E.g.) Being a plane figure with four equal straight sides and four right angles is a necessary and sufficient condition for being a square.

Often shortened to "iff"

How “if and only if” is related to validity

What we learned earlier

(1) Always valid

If A, then B (
A.
Therefore, B.

(2) Always valid

If A, then B
Not B.
Therefore, Not A.

(3) Always invalid

If A, then B
Not A.
Therefore, Not B.

(4) Always invalid

If A, then B
B.
Therefore, A.

What we learned earlier

(1) Always valid

A, only if B (
A.
Therefore, B.

(2) Always valid

A, only if B
Not B.
Therefore, Not A.

(3) Always invalid

A, only if B
Not A.
Therefore, Not B.

(4) Always invalid

A, only if B
B.
Therefore, A.

(1) Always valid

A, if and only if B (
A.
Therefore, B.

(2) Always valid

A, if and only if B
Not B.
Therefore, Not A.

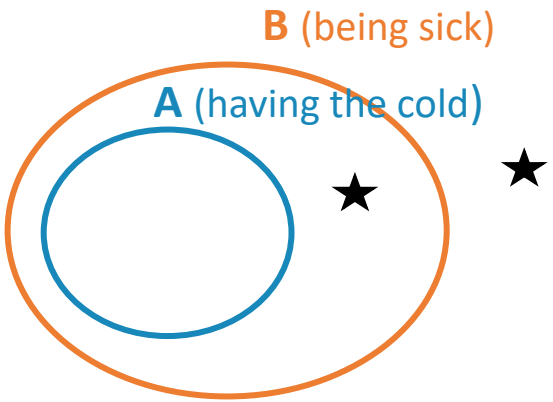
(3) Always **valid**

A, if and only if B
Not A.
Therefore, Not B.

(4) Always **valid**

A, if and only if B
B.
Therefore, A.

Always invalid argument form 1



P1. If A, then B (= B, if A)

P2. **Not A**

C. **Not B**

P1. If I have the cold, then I am sick.

P2. I do **not** have the cold

C. I am **not** sick.

P1. If Edward Cullen were a human, he would be mortal.

P2. Edward Cullen is **not** a human.

C. Edward Cullen is **not** mortal.

Invalid

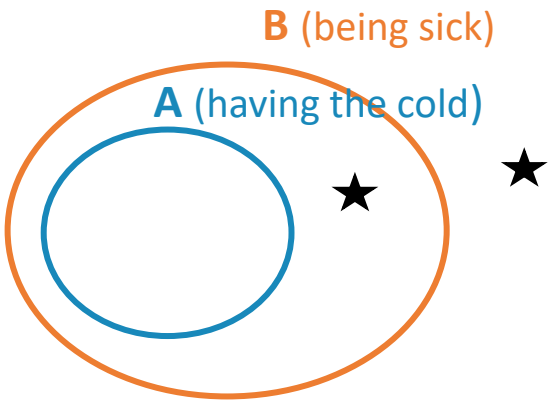
Valid or invalid?

Always invalid argument form 1

P1. If A, then B (= B, if A)

P2. **Not A**

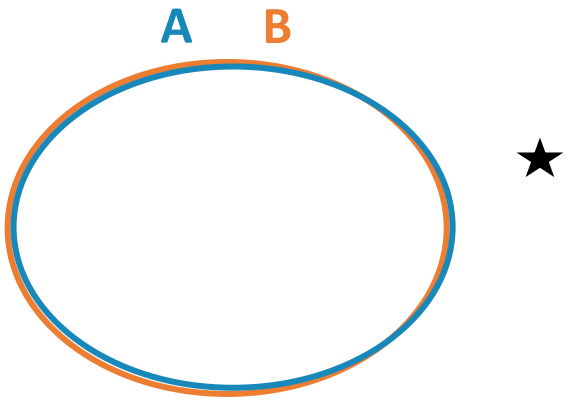
C. **Not B**



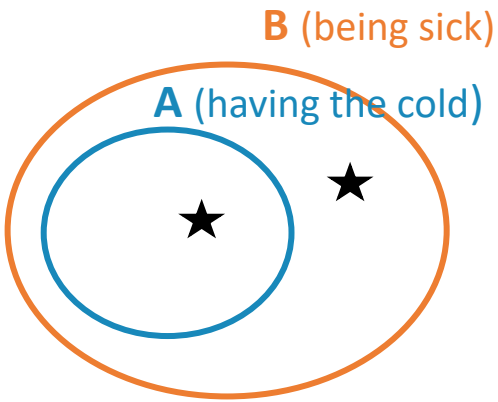
P1. A if and only if B (= B if and only if A)

P2. **Not A**

C. **Not B**



Always invalid argument form 2



P1. If A, then B (= B, if A)

P2. **B**

C. **A**

P1. If I have the cold, then I am sick.

P2. I am sick.

C. I have the cold.

P1. If Edward Cullen is a vampire, he is immortal.

P2. Edward Cullen is immortal.

C. Edward Cullen is a vampire.

Valid or invalid?

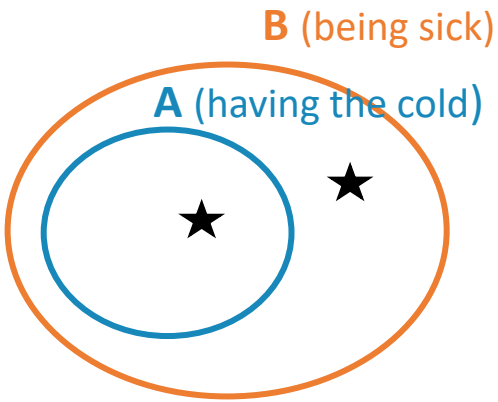
Invalid

Always invalid argument form 2

P1. If A, then B (= B, if A)

P2. **B**

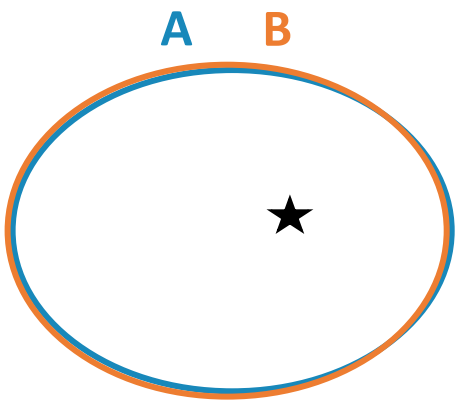
C. **A**



P1. A if and only if B (= B if and only if A)

P2. **B**

C. **A**

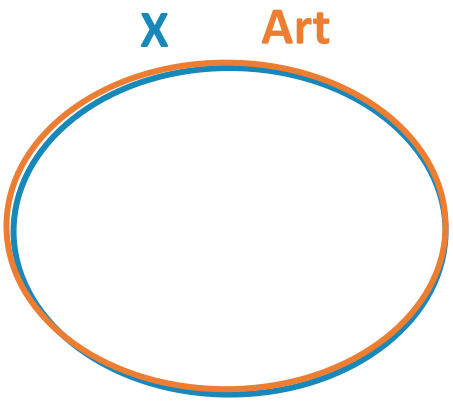


Going back to the definition of art…

The definition of art

X is (a) necessary and sufficient (condition) for being art

= all artworks have X, and no non-artworks have X.



Similar to….

Being a plane figure with four equal straight sides and four right angles is a necessary and sufficient condition for being a square.

Maurizio Cattelan
The Comedian (2019)

Marcel Duchamp
Fountain (1917)

What could be X?

Piero Manzoni
Artist's Shit (1961)

Vincent van Gogh
The Starry Night (1889)

Maurizio Cattelan
The Comedian (2019)

Marcel Duchamp
Fountain (1917)

What could be X?

Beautiful?

Piero Manzoni
Artist's Shit (1961)

Vincent van Gogh
The Starry Night (1889)

Maurizio Cattelan
The Comedian (2019)

Marcel Duchamp
Fountain (1917)

What could be X?

Piero Manzoni
Artist's Shit (1961)

Beautiful?

So, beauty is not [necessary or sufficient?]

Vincent van Gogh
The Starry Night (1889)

Maurizio Cattelan
The Comedian (2019)

Marcel Duchamp
Fountain (1917)

What could be X?

Beautiful?
(not necessary)

Piero Manzoni
Artist's Shit (1961)

Vincent van Gogh
The Starry Night (1889)

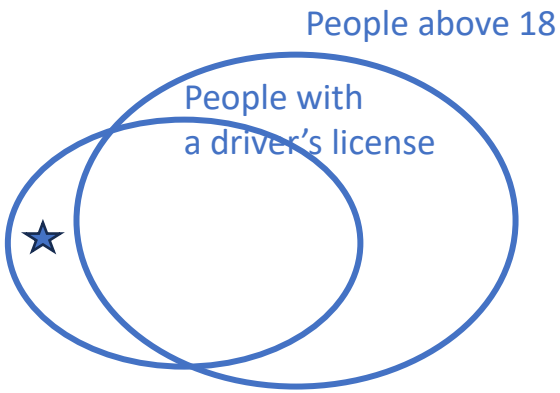
Necessary condition

X is (a) necessary (condition) for Y

= Y is a subset of X

= In order for Y to be the case, X has to be the case.

= It is not possible for something to be or do Y and not X.



E.g.) Being in Asia is a necessary condition for being in Singapore.

Being a rectangle is a necessary condition for being a square.

~~**Being above 18 is necessary for getting a driver's license**~~**.**

How can you show that X is **not** necessary for Y?

: find an example that is not X but Y

e.g.,) A friend of mine got their driver's license when they were 17

Maurizio Cattelan
The Comedian (2019)

Marcel Duchamp
Fountain (1917)

What could be X?

Beautiful?
(not necessary)

Is beauty sufficient?

Piero Manzoni
Artist's Shit (1961)

Vincent van Gogh
The Starry Night (1889)

Maurizio Cattelan
The Comedian (2019)

Marcel Duchamp
Fountain (1917)

What could be X?

Beautiful?
(not necessary, not sufficient)

Piero Manzoni
Artist's Shit (1961)

Vincent van Gogh
The Starry Night (1889)

Sufficient condition

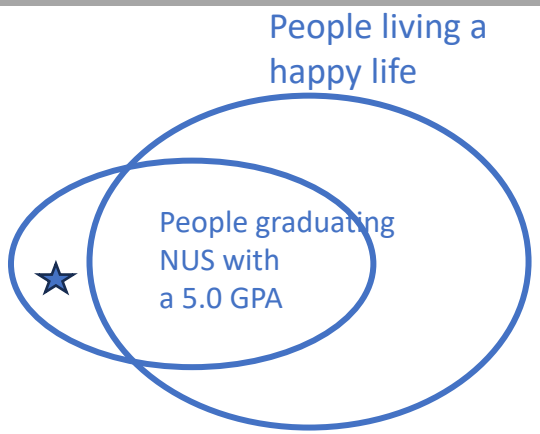
X is (a) sufficient (condition) for Y

= X is a subset of Y

= X 100% guarantees Y

= If X is the case, Y is the case (always).

= It is not possible for something to be or do X and not Y.



E.g.) Being in Singapore is a sufficient condition for being in Asia.

Being a square is a sufficient condition for being a rectangle.

Graduating NUS with a 5.0 GPA is a sufficient condition for living a happy life (probably false)

How to show that X is NOT sufficient for Y
: find an example that is X but not Y

e.g.,) Someone who graduated NUS with a 5.0 GPA but is not living a happy life

Levinson, “Defining Art Historically” (1979)

What makes something a work of art is not any exhibited property (i.e., something you can perceive) but something you cannot perceive, more specifically,

Maurizio Cattelan
The Comedian (2019)

Marcel Duchamp
Fountain (1917)

What could be X?

Beautiful?

Piero Manzoni
Artist's Shit (1961)

Levinson, “Defining Art Historically” (1979)

What makes something a work of art is not any exhibited property (i.e., something you can perceive) but something you cannot perceive, more specifically, its being intended to be regarded in certain ways—any of the ways works of art existing prior to it have been correctly regarded.

Levinson's definition of art

- What is the main claim?

"a work of art is a thing **intended** for regard-as-a-work-of-art: regard in any of the ways **works of art existing prior to it** have been correctly regarded" (p.234)

I intend this to be treated in [...] ways,

The Starry Night (1889)

Vincent van Gogh (from the movie *At Eternity's Gate*)

"for something to be an art work at any time is for it to be intentionally related to art works that precede it" (p.246)

Levinson's definition of art

- What is the main claim?

"a work of art is a thing **intended** for regard-as-a-work-of-art: regard in any of the ways **works of art existing prior to it** have been correctly regarded" (p.234)

More precisely,

"X is an artwork at t =df X is an object of which it is true at t that some person or persons having the appropriate proprietary right over X, non-passingly intends (or intended) X for regard-as-a-work-of-art, i.e. regard in any way (or ways) in which art works existing prior to t are or were correctly (or standardly) regarded." (p.238)

Let’s unpack

Levinson's definition of art

"X is an artwork at t =df X is an object of which it is true at t that some person or persons having the appropriate proprietary right over X, non-passingly intends (or intended) X for regard-as-a-work-of-art, i.e. regard in any way (or ways) in which art works existing prior to t are or were correctly (or standardly) regarded." (p.238)

- "What this amounts to is basically ownership—you cannot 'artify' what you do not own.. All your intentions will not avail in such a case, because another person's intention, that of the owner, has priority over yours" (p.237).

- Creating the physical object is neither necessary nor sufficient for ownership.

- Many originally non-art objects of the past being exhibited at art museums might fail to satisfy this condition

  e.g.) A sacred ritual object from an ancient Mexican culture being exhibited at a (non-Mexican) art museum. Descendants of that culture demand the removal of the object from public view. → not art, according to Levinson

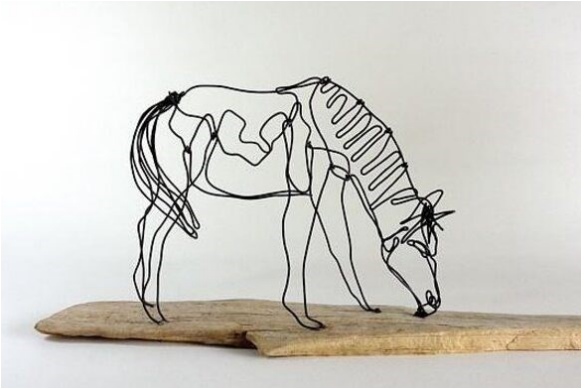
Levinson's definition of art

"X is an artwork at t =df X is an object of which it is true at t that some person or persons having the appropriate proprietary right over X, non-passingly intends (or intended) X for regard-as-a-work-of-art, i.e. regard in any way (or ways) in which art works existing prior to t are or were correctly (or standardly) regarded." (p.238)

Any of the following three kinds of intention can satisfy this condition:

1. Specific art-conscious intention: "intending for regard in the specific way or ways some particular past art works (or class of artworks) have been correctly regarded."(p.237)

   e.g.) "intending for regard in the way wire sculptures are to be regarded" (p.237)



Levinson's definition of art

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   e.g.) "intending for regard in the way wire sculptures are to be regarded" (p.237)

2. Non-specific art-conscious intention: "intending for regard in whatever ways any past art works have been correctly regarded, having no particular ones in mind." (p.237)

3. Art-unconscious intention: "intending for regard in some specific way ϕ characterized in terms of intrinsic features, where ϕ is in fact a way in which some past art works have been correctly regarded, though this fact is not known to the intender."(p.237)

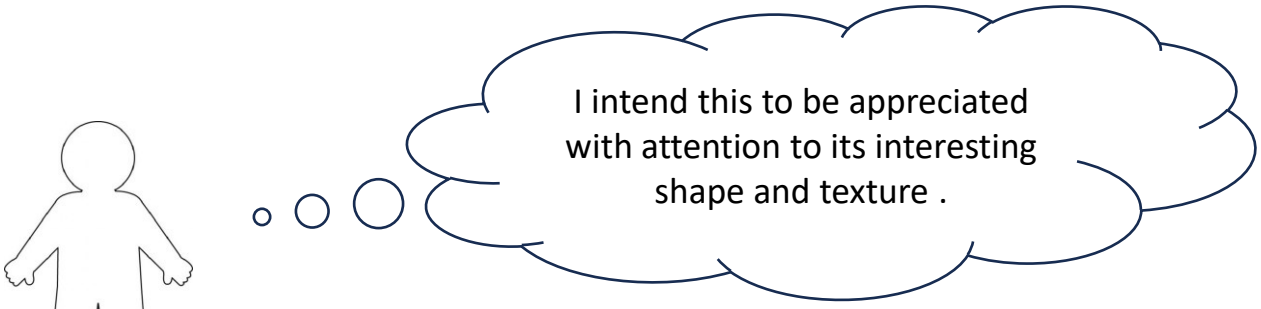
   e.g.) "intending for listening to with attention to timbre", aesthetic appreciation

Why include art-unconscious intention?

"my definition thus allows (via the art-unconscious intention) for an art-maker ignorant of all art works, all art activities, and all institutions of art." (p.238)

leave quietly or sneak away without being noticed

"Consider a solitary Indian along the Amazon, who steals off from his non-artistic tribe to arrange coloured stones in a clearing, not outwardly investing them with special position in the world. Might not this also be art (and, note, before any future curator decides that it is)?" (p.233)



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"Consider the farmer's wife at a country fair in Nebraska, who sets an assemblage of egg shells and white glue down on the corner of a table for folks to look at. Isn't it possible that she has created art? Yet she and the artworld exist in perfect mutual oblivion." (p.233)

Levinson's definition of art

"X is an artwork at t =df X is an object of which it is true at t that some person or persons having the appropriate proprietary right over X, non-passingly intends (or intended) X for regard-as-a-work-of-art, i.e. regard in any way (or ways) in which art works existing prior to t are or were correctly (or standardly) regarded." (p.238)

"An object can be an artwork at one time and not another." (p.238)

e.g.) an object physically created at one time becomes art later (e.g., *Fountain*)

Marcel Duchamp
Fountain (1917)

Levinson's definition of art

"X is an artwork at t =df X is an object of which it is true at t that some person or persons having the appropriate proprietary right over X, non-passingly intends (or intended) X for regard-as-a-work-of-art, i.e. regard in any way (or ways) in which art works existing prior to t are or were correctly (or standardly) regarded." (p.238)

"An object can be an artwork at one time and not another." (p.238)

e.g.) an object physically created at one time becomes art later (e.g., *Fountain*)

e.g.) someone intends an object for a certain regard at t1, which only later at t2 becomes regard-as-a-work-of-art: the object wasn't art at t1. It becomes art at t2.

I intend this to be regarded in X way.

I'm a work of art now!

2026 (X is not a regard-as-a-work-of-art)

2126 (X is a regard-as-a-work-of-art)

Levinson's definition of art

"X is an artwork at t =df X is an object of which it is true at t that some person or persons having the appropriate proprietary right over X, non-passingly intends (or intended) X for regard-as-a-work-of-art, i.e. regard in any way (or ways) in which art works existing prior to t are or were correctly (or standardly) regarded." (p.238)

What happens if the definition doesn't include "correctly":

"Italian Renaissance portraits are presumably art works. Suppose that they come to be regarded in a new and unprecedented way, viz. they begin to be used as thermal insulation, and are found to be quite suitable for this. And suppose, through an amazing decline in taste or an unparalleled need for insulation, this manner of regard becomes the rule. If we omit 'correctly' from our definition, or replace it by 'commonly' or 'rewardingly', then given the case as described, it follows from our definition that anything subsequently intended by its maker for use as insulation (e.g. a sheet of fibreglass) would be an art work…. Using Renaissance portraits as insulation is manifestly not a correct way of regarding them, no matter how widespread or satisfactory such a use might be." (p.236)

Levinson's definition of art

"X is an artwork at t =df X is an object of which it is true at t that some person or persons having the appropriate proprietary right over X, non-passingly intends (or intended) X for regard-as-a-work-of-art, i.e. regard in any way (or ways) in which art works existing prior to t are or were correctly (or standardly) regarded." (p.238)

"the intent must be fairly stable ('non-passing'), as opposed to merely transient. In other words, it is not enough to turn an object into art that one momentarily considers it for regard-as-a-work-of-art." (p.236)

An objection to Levinson’s definition of art

(more objections discussed in the reading)

Objection: What about revolutionary art?

- Objection:

According to Levinson's definition, revolutionary art, "intended for treatment in a manner completely distinct from what has gone before" (p.241), can't be art.

Marcel Duchamp
Fountain (1917)

Levinson's definition of art

- What is the main claim?

"a work of art is a thing **intended** for regard-as-a-work-of-art: regard in any of the ways **works of art existing prior to it** have been correctly regarded" (p.234)

More precisely,

"X is an artwork at t =df X is an object of which it is true at t that some person or persons having the appropriate proprietary right over X, non-passingly intends (or intended) X for regard-as-a-work-of-art, i.e. regard in any way (or ways) in which art works existing prior to t are or were correctly (or standardly) regarded." (p.238)

Objection: What about revolutionary art?

- Objection:

According to Levinson's definition, revolutionary art, "intended for treatment in a manner completely distinct from what has gone before" (p.241), can't be art.

My definition can explain how revolutionary art is possible.

"'although the consciously revolutionary artist desires that eventually his objects will be dealt with in unprecedented ways, to make them art he must initially direct his audience to take them (or try taking them) in some way that art has been taken…The art-making intention of the consciously revolutionary artist may thus have to be a covertly disingenuous one, somewhat along these lines: 'My object is for regarding in any way art works have been regarded in the past (but with the expectation that this will prove frustrating or unrewarding, thus prodding the spectator to adopt some other point of view—this being my real intention).' The secondary intention embodies the true aim of such art, but the primary intention must be present to make it art at all." (p.241)

What to do this week

- Do the reading for next lecture

  : Nagel, “Death”